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Control Your AI Mind

Detailed Source Extraction Notes For Teaching

Corpus date: 2026-06-10

Use policy: These are teaching notes extracted and synthesized from the private corpus. They are not full-text reproductions.

This document answers the practical question: **what exactly should be taken from each source for the course?** Each entry gives the teaching extraction, where it belongs in the syllabus, an applied exercise, and the risk to emphasize.

Paul GP: Getting Started with Claude Code

Teaching extraction. Terminal agent as research RA; context window; tool ladder; installation; local filesystem; write state to files; focused sessions.

Where to use it. Use as Module 2 opening lecture and first live demo. Students learn what changes when the model can read files and run code.

Applied exercise. Have students create a clean project folder, ask the agent to summarize files, then write progress.md and restart from it.

Risk / caution. Students may think installation is the point. Redirect to context, state, and scoped work.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Paul GP: From an Empty Folder to a Figure

Teaching extraction. Descriptive research workflow from vague question to source discovery, download, script, plot, and verification.

Where to use it. Use as first applied lab because it is visible, low-risk, and close to real scoping work.

Applied exercise. Replicate with a new public dataset: define question, preserve raw data, script processing, create figure, write reproducibility note.

Risk / caution. Convenient source may not match concept. Require source definition check before interpretation.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Paul GP: From EDGAR Filings to a Structured Database

Teaching extraction. Text-as-data pipeline: sample list, raw filings, caching, parsing, DuckDB/SQLite, metadata, keyword/context tables, quality report.

Where to use it. Use to teach that database is the deliverable, not scraping itself.

Applied exercise. Build mini database from 10 web pages or filings with raw cache, parse script, schema, and quality report.

Risk / caution. Students may stop after downloaded text. Force schema and queryable output.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Paul GP: Large Datasets and Structured Databases

Teaching extraction. Large admin data: CSV-to-parquet, DuckDB, schema harmonization, metadata table, aggregate tables, sanity checks.

Where to use it. Use for intermediate/advanced applied economics students who work with VHLSS/admin/panel data.

Applied exercise. Take one large-ish CSV, convert to parquet, query with DuckDB, create metadata table, build aggregate table.

Risk / caution. Agents can write fast code but may hide format/version breaks. Require test years and sanity checks.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Paul GP: Writing & Thinking with AI Assistance

Teaching extraction. Writing as thinking; cognitive offloading; style guides; comments-only editing; referee-report/revision skills.

Where to use it. Use to teach writing discipline after students have data artifacts.

Applied exercise. Run claim audit; ask AI for comments only; student rewrites manually; create style guide.

Risk / caution. Students overuse full rewrites. Ban rewrites until claim audit is complete.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Paul GP: Skills: Specifying How an Agent Should Think

Teaching extraction. Skills as reusable instruction bundles; trigger descriptions; project vs global skills; testing and iteration.

Where to use it. Use to teach how to encode repeated judgment.

Applied exercise. Create SKILL.md for paper summary, data audit, or DiD verification; test on two examples.

Risk / caution. Students treat skills as magic. Emphasize that skills load text and standardize behavior.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Paul GP: Permissions, Sandboxes, and Autonomous Agents

Teaching extraction. Folder permissions vs tool permissions; manual/auto/full modes; containers; safehouse; data exposure; autonomous agents.

Where to use it. Use for safety lecture before any broad-permission workflow.

Applied exercise. Have students classify tasks by permission level and design a sandbox boundary.

Risk / caution. Sandboxing file actions does not solve remote model privacy. Teach separately.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Paul GP: AI and the Research O-Ring

Teaching extraction. Research quality as chain of inputs; AI accelerates parts but can amplify human bottlenecks; surface artifacts are cheap.

Where to use it. Use as conceptual anchor for entire course.

Applied exercise. Ask students to map one paper into O-ring inputs and identify the weakest link under AI acceleration.

Risk / caution. Students may become either hype-driven or nihilistic. Teach balanced control discipline.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Paul GP: LLM-Friendly Academic Papers

Teaching extraction. Papers should be easier for humans and machines to parse: structure, clear claims, metadata, source discipline.

Where to use it. Use in writing/research communication module.

Applied exercise. Students redesign one paper section to be easier to parse: summary, claims, data, identification, limitations.

Risk / caution. Do not optimize only for machines; human clarity remains first.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Aniket Panjwani: Claude Code From Scratch full course

Teaching extraction. Beginner onboarding; terminal/interface basics; permissions; hooks; skills; Claude.md debate; practical early wins.

Where to use it. Use for pacing and practical demo style.

Applied exercise. Design first-30-minute onboarding session for nontechnical economists.

Risk / caution. Tool enthusiasm can outrun research discipline. Add source/verification layer.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Aniket Panjwani: OpenAI Codex Full Course

Teaching extraction. Codex desktop interface; agents in parallel; context/compaction; permissions; AGENTS.md; sub-agents; MCPs; GitHub; deployment.

Where to use it. Use for Research-Agent OS module and modern tool surface overview.

Applied exercise. Students create a project board with tasks, run parallel source summarizer and critic agents, then review outputs.

Risk / caution. Parallel agents can produce more unverified material faster. Require synthesis/review step.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Aniket Panjwani: AI Agents for Economics Research / AI-MBA tutorial

Teaching extraction. Practical workflows for economists; agentic coding as leverage for research and business tasks.

Where to use it. Use as bridge between tool training and economist-facing use cases.

Applied exercise. Students translate one economics workflow into agent primitives: files, search, code, memory, review.

Risk / caution. Avoid teaching tool recipes detached from research outputs.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Stanford IRiSS: Empirical Work in the Age of AI

Teaching extraction. Institutional framing: AI may change research quality, quantity, type of work, and publication/review pressure.

Where to use it. Use as first-session motivation and discussion.

Applied exercise. Class debate: what parts of empirical work improve, what gets noisier, what norms must change?

Risk / caution. Do not make unsupported predictions. Treat as agenda-setting, not settled evidence.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Scott Cunningham: Claude Code 53 / Applied econometrics checklist

Teaching extraction. Automation requires pre-specified estimand, cohort tables, rollout plots, covariate logic, outcome paths, package/version checks; zero-error constraint.

Where to use it. Use as core verification module and applied econometrics warning.

Applied exercise. Build DiD/CSDID checklist before estimation; run on toy panel; write verification memo.

Risk / caution. Students may believe agent output because it is technical. Human capital is needed to spot weird failures.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Scott Cunningham + Aniket: Interview on economics research and returns to expertise

Teaching extraction. Agentic AI increases returns to expertise; verification remains slower than production; coauthor/RA review can reveal hidden problems.

Where to use it. Use in advanced discussion after students have experienced agent speed.

Applied exercise. Compare two workflows: fast solo agent run vs agent + human review + checklist.

Risk / caution. Do not frame expertise as optional. Agent leverage depends on expertise.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Chris Blattman: Claude Blattman

Teaching extraction. Non-coder AI workflows: project folders, plan review, meetings, dashboards, skill/templates, executive assistant style systems.

Where to use it. Use for managers/researchers who need knowledge-work workflows beyond code.

Applied exercise. Students build one recurring workflow: meeting-to-tasks, proposal review, weekly project dashboard.

Risk / caution. Productivity tools still need privacy, source, and review boundaries.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Pedro Sant'Anna: Claude Code academic workflow

Teaching extraction. Academic lifecycle orchestration: skills, slash commands, agents, quality gates, hooks, simulated peer review, reproducibility.

Where to use it. Use as advanced OS architecture reference.

Applied exercise. Students design their own minimal academic workflow with 3 skills, 2 hooks/checks, and one quality gate.

Risk / caution. Do not copy the full system blindly; adapt to project maturity.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Yiqing Xu / StatsClaw: StatsClaw

Teaching extraction. AI collaboration for statistical software; method implementation needs tests, reproducibility, and domain validation.

Where to use it. Use for advanced statistical software and methods modules.

Applied exercise. Students write benchmark tests for one estimator or compare package outputs on simulated data.

Risk / caution. Passing code tests is not econometric correctness.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Pedro Sant'Anna / TripleDiff: Triple differences workflow/package

Teaching extraction. Modern causal-inference tooling; triple differences require careful estimand, applications, package use, and interpretation.

Where to use it. Use in verification/case study module.

Applied exercise. Students write a triple-diff verification checklist: groups, timing, contrasts, identifying assumptions, robustness.

Risk / caution. Triple differences are easy to describe and hard to verify.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Jeremy Nguyen: AI writing/productivity and PubMed/delve example

Teaching extraction. AI writing leaves detectable patterns; writing productivity must be balanced with originality and evidence.

Where to use it. Use as short caution in writing module.

Applied exercise. Students identify AI-sounding writing tics and rewrite a paragraph with evidence-specific language.

Risk / caution. Avoid turning style policing into substance; claim support matters more.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Andrej Karpathy: English as programming language / understanding cannot be outsourced

Teaching extraction. Natural language becomes a programming interface, but comprehension cannot be delegated.

Where to use it. Use as memorable framing for Module 1.

Applied exercise. Students write one task in English as executable specification, then list what still requires understanding.

Risk / caution. Do not romanticize English prompts; structure still matters.

Instructor move. Do not present this source as a passive reading. Turn it into a classroom artifact: a task contract, checklist, lab, or verification memo.

Cross-Source Synthesis

1. Practical Sequence To Borrow From Paul + Aniket

A strong applied course sequence is:

1. Tool orientation and setup.

2. Context window and session-state discipline.
3. Permissions and data boundaries.
4. Blank folder to figure.
5. Scrape/source to structured database.
6. Large data workflow with DuckDB/parquet.
7. Writing and comments-only editing.
8. Skill creation.
9. Verification/O-ring and econometrics checklist.
10. Research-agent OS capstone.

This sequence works because it moves from visible, low-risk outputs to judgment-heavy outputs. It also gives students quick wins without pretending that quick wins are research validity.

2. What To Teach As Mindset

- The agent is an operator, not an author of truth.
- The human owns the research design and interpretation.
- Every output needs provenance.
- Context should be engineered, not dumped.
- Skills encode repeated judgment, not truth.
- Verification is part of production.
- Expertise becomes more valuable when production becomes cheaper.

3. What To Teach As Tool Skill

- Navigate project folders.
- Let the agent inspect but not roam.
- Use git for rollback.
- Save progress to files.
- Split sessions by objective.
- Use permissions deliberately.
- Use sub-agents for parallel research only with synthesis review.
- Use MCPs/external APIs only when source boundaries and credentials are clear.
- Use DuckDB/parquet for large structured data.
- Use comments-only editing for important prose.

4. What To Teach As Economics Discipline

- Unit of observation.
- Sample construction.
- Source vintage and version.
- Missingness.
- Weights and aggregation.
- Fixed effects and clustering.
- Estimand before estimator.
- Descriptive vs associational vs causal claims.
- Robustness and falsification.
- Economic significance.

5. What To Avoid

- Course centered on prompt lists.
- Course centered on one tool's UI.
- Full automation demos without verification.
- Letting students submit chat transcripts instead of artifacts.
- Treating generated prose as evidence.
- Treating skills as interchangeable downloads.
- Publishing full scraped text/transcripts on the website.